GOURMET EGGLESS NUTELLA BROWNIES

Deep chocolate · roasted hazelnut · glossy Nutella ribbons · fudgy centre

YIELD	TIN	OVEN	BAKE
16 squares	20 × 20 cm	170°C conventional	28–35 minutes*

Texture: A dense, moist brownie with a delicate crackly top, toasted hazelnut pieces and distinct Nutella ribbons. This recipe is completely eggless and uses yoghurt for structure and moisture; no commercial egg replacer is required.

INGREDIENTS

Chocolate base

Ingredient	Quantity
Dark couverture chocolate (60–70%)	180 g
Unsalted butter	150 g
Nutella	150 g

Yoghurt-sugar mixture

Ingredient	Quantity
Caster sugar	125 g
Light brown sugar	65 g
Thick Greek yoghurt, room temperature	100 g
Whole milk	35 g
Vanilla bean paste	5 g

Dry ingredients and inclusions

Ingredient	Quantity
Plain flour	95 g
Dutch-process cocoa powder	25 g
Skimmed milk powder	12 g
Cornflour	8 g
Fine sea salt	2 g

Ingredient	Quantity
Instant espresso powder	2 g
Roasted hazelnuts, roughly chopped	55 g

Nutella swirl

Ingredient	Quantity
Nutella	100 g
Warm cream, only if needed to loosen	up to 10 g

METHOD

1. Prepare the tin and oven

Line a 20 × 20 cm square metal tin with baking parchment, leaving an overhang on two sides. Preheat a conventional oven to 170°C. Use top-and-bottom heat without the fan if your oven allows. Position the rack in the centre.

2. Melt the butter and chocolate

Cut the butter into pieces and melt gently in a saucepan over low heat. Remove the pan from the heat before adding the chopped dark couverture. Leave for about 1 minute, then stir slowly with a silicone spatula until completely smooth. Do not let the chocolate mixture become hot or scorched.

3. Incorporate the first Nutella portion

Add 150 g Nutella to the warm chocolate-butter mixture. Fold until the mixture is uniform, glossy and cohesive. Set aside until warm rather than hot; it should remain fluid but must not feel hot to the touch.

4. Make the yoghurt-sugar emulsion

In a separate bowl, combine the Greek yoghurt, caster sugar, light brown sugar, milk and vanilla. Whisk by hand for about 1–2 minutes until smooth and evenly combined. The sugar will not necessarily dissolve completely; aim for a homogeneous mixture without yoghurt lumps.

5. Combine wet mixtures

Gradually pour the warm chocolate-Nutella mixture into the yoghurt mixture while whisking gently. Whisk only until the mixture becomes evenly coloured, smooth and glossy. Avoid vigorous beating or whipping air into the batter.

6. Combine the dry ingredients

Sift the plain flour, cocoa powder, skimmed milk powder, cornflour, salt and espresso powder together. Add the dry mixture to the wet mixture in two additions. Use a silicone spatula to fold: scrape down the side, cut through the centre, lift from the bottom and turn the batter over. Stop as soon as no dry pockets remain.

7. Add the hazelnuts

Fold in the roasted, chopped hazelnuts, distributing them evenly without overworking the batter. The finished mixture should be thick, dense and glossy—not airy or pourable like cake batter.

8. Fill the tin

Transfer the batter into the lined tin. Scrape the bowl thoroughly with the spatula and spread the batter into the corners in an even layer. Tap the tin once or twice gently on the worktop to settle large air pockets; do not knock out all the density.

9. Create the Nutella swirl

Spoon 100 g Nutella in small portions over the surface. If it is too stiff to spoon, stir in a little warm cream, up to 10 g, just until loosened. Draw a skewer through the Nutella in broad S-shaped movements. Make only a few passes so the ribbons remain distinct; excessive swirling will erase them.

10. Bake

Bake at 170°C conventional heat for approximately 28–35 minutes. Begin checking at 28 minutes. The edges should look set and the top should be crackled. A skewer inserted near the centre should come out with thick, moist crumbs attached, not clean and not coated in liquid batter. If the centre is visibly liquid, continue baking in 2–3 minute increments.

11. Cool and chill

Cool the brownies completely in the tin on a rack. Once at room temperature, cover and refrigerate for at least 6 hours, preferably overnight. Chilling firms the fudgy crumb and makes clean slicing possible. Do not cut while warm if neat squares are required.

12. Slice and serve

Lift the slab out using the parchment. Warm a long, sharp knife in hot water, wipe it completely dry, and make one clean cut. Wipe the blade between every cut. For the best eating texture, allow the squares to stand at room temperature for 15–20 minutes before serving.

PROFESSIONAL FINISHING

For a restrained pâtisserie finish, add a few finely chopped toasted hazelnuts, a light drizzle of melted dark couverture and two or three flakes of sea salt. Keep the decoration minimal: the crackly top and Nutella ribbons should remain the focus.

TROUBLESHOOTING & TECHNICAL CONTROL

Brownies are cakey: The batter may have been overmixed, too much air may have been incorporated, or the brownies may have been overbaked. Fold gently and remove them when the centre is set but still fudgy.

Centre is raw or liquid: Return the tin to the oven for 2–3 minutes at a time. Do not rely on the top colour alone; check the centre with a skewer for thick crumbs rather than liquid batter.

Nutella swirl disappears: The Nutella may have been too fluid or over-swirled. Use it at a spoonable consistency and make only a few broad skewer movements.

Brownies crumble when cut: They may not have cooled or chilled long enough. Chill thoroughly and use a warm, dry knife, cleaning the blade between cuts.

Greasy or split appearance: The chocolate mixture may have been too hot when combined with the yoghurt mixture, or the wet ingredients may have been incorporated too abruptly. Let the chocolate mixture cool until warm and whisk gradually.

STORAGE

Store in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 5 days. For the best fudgy texture, bring to room temperature for 15–20 minutes before serving. For longer storage, wrap individual squares well and freeze for up to 2 months; thaw overnight in the refrigerator.

THE CURLY CHEF · Crafted for deep chocolate flavour, balanced sweetness and a properly fudgy crumb.

Oven performance varies. Baking time is a guide; use the visual and skewer cues above as the final test. All ingredients listed are eggless. Check packaging if preparing for someone with an egg allergy, as cross-contact and manufacturing statements vary by brand.